

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: West

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 3
♥ A K 9 7 5
♦ Q 9 5
♣ 6 3

♠ K Q 6

♥ Q 10 4

♦ J

♣ A J 9 8 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 7 5 2

♥ 8 2

♦ 10 7 6 4 3

♣ K 7

♠ A 10 4

♥ J 6 3

♦ A K 8 2

♣ Q 10 5

West	North	East	South
1♥	2♣	Pass	1♦
Pass	3NT		3♣
All Pass			

3NT by North
then try to run the ♣Q.

[showcards W:H8 N:HJ]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥8, dummy played the ♥J

Play the ♥9. North played dummy's ♥J to tempt you to cover. Don't fall for it.

Partner's lead of a high spot card shows no honors in the suit. That added to the fact that North bid Notrump after you had mentioned ♥s is pretty good evidence that North holds at least ♥Q x x.

To maintain communication with partner your best hope is to duck the first ♥, but to signal encouragement with the ♥9.

North wins the first trick easily, but must try to establish ♣s. He will enter dummy with the ♠A,

Not today. Partner takes the ♣K and returns his ♥2 to your four winners.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 9 3
 ♥ K Q J 5
 ♦ 9 3
 ♣ Q J 10

♠ 8 4

♥ 9 7 3

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ A 6 5 3



♠ A 10 7 5

♥ A 8 2

♦ K Q

♣ K 8 7 4

♠ K 6 2

♥ 10 6 4

♦ A J 6 5 4

♣ 9 2

West

North

East

South

2♣

Pass

2♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

1NT with either 5-4-2-2 or 5-4-3-1 distribution.

[showcards W:C9 N:CT]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♣9, dummy played the ♣10

Play the ♣6.

Partner's ♣9 is likely from a short suit. If it is a singleton, you should take the ♣A immediately and return the suit for a ruff. If it is a doubleton, you should NOT take your ♣A now, but should hope partner can get the lead and play his second ♣ to your Ace so you can give him the ruff.

You can figure out which it is.

If it is a singleton, then East must hold 5 ♣s. But you know East has 4 ♠s, so if he also has 5 ♣s then he only has 4 red cards, and he would not have opened

So partner's ♣9 is not a singleton, and you should wait. Declarer then runs dummy's ♠Q. Partner wins the ♠K, returns his OTHER ♣ to your ♣A, and NOW you give him the ruff. He takes the ♦A for down 1.

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 3

♥ 10 2

♦ Q J 8 6 4 2

♣ 8 3

♠ 6 5 2

♥ J 9 8

♦ 9 5

♣ K J 10 9 7



♠ Q J 9 7

♥ K Q 6 5 3

♦ 10

♣ A 6 4

♠ A K 4

♥ A 7 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ Q 5 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Dbl

Pass

2 ♣

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

♥s to enter dummy and he will never get to enjoy those two ♣ winners.

[showcards W:HT N:HJ]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥10, dummy played the ♥J

Play the ♥6.

Declarer gets two ♥ winners whether you play one of your honors on this trick or not. So why does it matter what you do?

Suppose you cover with your ♥Q. South will win his ♥A, then play ♣s until your ♣A is forced out on the third round. He can then force an entry to dummy in the ♥ suit to reach the two ♣ winners.

Now suppose you duck the ♥J. Again South will push ♣s, and again you hold up until the third round. Ahh, what a difference. Now declarer cannot use the

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 3
 ♥ A J 3
 ♦ K 10 9 2
 ♣ 9 7 3

♠ Q
 ♥ 10 9 6 5 2
 ♦ J 8 6 3
 ♣ 6 4 2



♠ 7 5 4 2
 ♥ K Q
 ♦ A 5
 ♣ K J 10 8 5

♠ K 10 9 8 6
 ♥ 8 7 4
 ♦ Q 7 4
 ♣ A Q

West	North	East	South
		1♣	1♠
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West contract could no longer be beaten.			

[showcards W:SQ N:S2]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠Q, a low card was played from dummy,

Play the ♠K.

It seems that perhaps you should play low and let partner's ♠Q force out West's ♠A. Then, when you get the lead with a high ♣ you can force out West's ♠J. Get the lead with your other high ♣ and set the contract with ♠s.

Suppose you try that. Play low on the first ♠. West will also play low and North will be left holding the trick, and also holding the bag! With no more ♠s North will have to play one of the other three suits, and that is just what West wants to have happen. The

Now do it the right way. Play your ♠K on partner's ♠Q. Assume West takes the trick, although it doesn't matter whether he wins the first one or holds up. When you win your first ♣ drive out West's ♠J. When you win your second ♣ trick your ♠s will be good. If you overtake the first trick the contract can no longer be made.

Notice that West will always make two ♠ tricks, so your overtake costs nothing.